

# AGENT SLAM 2026 – Official Competition Rulebook

**Date:** March 28–29, 2026

**Total Prize Pool:** ₹30,000

## 1. Event Overview

**AGENT SLAM** is a competitive "Battle of the Agents" where student-built AI models engage in live, automated debates. Teams develop agents capable of interfacing with a central API to argue complex topics in Finance, Marketing, and Ethics. The goal is to move beyond simple chatbots and engineer strategic debaters capable of swaying an autonomous "Judging Bot" known as **The Oracle**.

### 2.1 Team Structure & Composition

- **Team Size:** Each team must consist of **exactly 3 members**.

**Departmental Requirement:** At least **2 members must be currently enrolled in the Computer Science & Engineering (CSE) department**. These CSE members must be from **different academic years**.

**Wildcard Slot:** The **third member may belong to any department**, and there is **no restriction on the academic year** for this member.

### 2.2 Model Development Flexibility

Participants are free to choose how they design and implement their debate agents.

Teams may **use existing AI models, frameworks, or APIs** (such as open-source LLMs or publicly available models) as part of their agent architecture.

Teams may also **design and implement their own custom models or systems from scratch** if they prefer.

Hybrid approaches combining **existing models with custom logic, prompting strategies, or additional components** are also permitted.

All approaches are allowed as long as the final agent **complies with the competition rules, API specifications, and repository transparency requirements**.



### 3. Competition Format

The competition will be conducted in a **single-stage knockout format**.

All matches will follow a **1 vs. 1 format**, where one team competes directly against another team through their AI agents. Each match is a **knockout match**, meaning one team advances while the other is eliminated. The winner of each match will be determined solely based on the **score assigned by the Judging Bot for that match**.

In the **first round**, teams will be paired **lottery based or randomly** and compete against a randomly assigned opponent.

In **each round**, the winning teams advance to the next, while the losing teams are eliminated.

This process will continue in a **single-elimination format** until the final match.

#### Special Cases:

If there is an **odd number of teams in any round (except the first round)**, the team with the **highest score from the previous round** will automatically advance to the next round.

If there is an **odd number of teams in the first round**, an **additional preliminary match** will be conducted between two randomly selected teams. The losing team of this match will be eliminated, ensuring an even number of teams for the main bracket.

### 4.1 Debate Structure

Each match consists of a series of automated exchanges between competing agents.

There is **no fixed limit on the number of conversational exchanges within a match**.

**Agents may continue debating until the 15-minute match duration expires.**

Agents may structure their arguments dynamically based on the topic, the opponent's responses, and their overall debate strategy.

While agents are free to structure their responses in any manner, the following debate styles are recommended approaches that can help structure effective arguments:

### **Opening Statement**

An agent may begin by introducing its primary stance on the topic. This typically includes presenting the core argument, outlining key reasoning, and introducing any supporting evidence or examples.

### **Rebuttal**

Agents may respond directly to claims made by the opponent by challenging their reasoning, highlighting logical weaknesses, or presenting counter-evidence.

### **Cross-Examination**

Agents may question the assumptions, logic, or data used by the opponent. This approach focuses on identifying inconsistencies, flawed reasoning, or unsupported claims.

### **Defense / Counter-Argument**

Agents may strengthen their position by addressing the opponent's criticisms while reinforcing their original arguments with additional reasoning or clarification.

### **Closing Argument**

Agents may conclude by summarizing their key points and reinforcing why their position is stronger, aiming to leave a clear and persuasive final impression on the Oracle (Judging Bot).

It is recommended for the bot to keep the closing argument instead of just always rebutting.

Participants are encouraged to use these approaches as guidelines for structuring arguments, but agents are free to adapt their strategy based on the flow of the debate.

## **4.2 Response Timing Rules**

To ensure fairness and smooth execution of the debate, the following timing constraints will be enforced:

### **Initial Response Time**

The **first message** from each agent must be submitted **within 2 minutes** of the match starting. Failure to do so will result in a **penalty or, possibly, a disqualification for that match**.

### Subsequent Response Time

For all subsequent exchanges, an agent must respond **within 2 minutes** after receiving the opponent's message.

Any response that exceeds the **2-minute limit** will **not be considered by the judging bot** during evaluation.

Participants should ensure their agents are capable of generating responses **within the specified time limits** to avoid penalties.

## 5. Official Rules & Constraints

| Category      | Rule Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Payload Limit | Max 3,000 characters per turn; valid JSON format required.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Autonomy      | Zero human intervention once the <code>START_DEBATE</code> signal is sent.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Hallucination | Participants must ensure that their agents provide <b>accurate and verifiable information</b> during debates. Any attempt to strengthen arguments by citing <b>fabricated statistics, non-existent research, or fake laws and regulations</b> will result in a <b>penalty during evaluation</b> . Repeated instances of such misinformation may lead to <b>severe score deductions</b>                                                                                                                                 |
| Conduct       | <p>All participants must adhere to the following guidelines:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>● Agents must not attempt to exploit or disrupt the competition infrastructure.</li><li>● Offensive, abusive, or toxic content in arguments is strictly prohibited.</li><li>● Agents will get an error message if they try to communicate during the opponent's turn</li></ul> <p>Any attempt to interfere with another team's agent or API communication will result in <b>immediate disqualification</b>.</p> |

## 6. Scoring Matrix

The Judging Bot evaluates arguments during a match using the following weighted criteria.

These scores are **used solely to determine the match winner and are not accumulated across matches.**

- **Persuasiveness (40%):** Use of rhetoric, evidence, and narrative.
- **Logic (30%):** Internal consistency and avoidance of logical fallacies.
- **API Robustness (20%):** Correct headers, formatting, and response speed.
- **Agility (10%):** How well the agent adapts to the opponent's unique points.

The team with the **higher total score at the end of the match is declared the winner.**

### 6.1 Match Result and Leaderboard

Each debate match is evaluated by **The Oracle (Judging Bot)** using the scoring matrix defined above.

Both participants receive a **score between 0 and 100** based on their debate performance.

The participant with the **higher score in that match is declared the winner.**

### 6.2 Default Scoring for Special Cases

In certain situations where a match cannot be completed normally, the following scoring rules will apply:

#### **Opponent Disqualification / Forfeit**

If a participant is disqualified, absent, or unable to participate in a match, the opposing team will be declared the winner by forfeit. In such cases, the disqualified or absent team will receive a score of 0 from the Judging Bot, resulting in an automatic forfeit.

## 7. API Integration

All agents must interact with the competition platform through an **official API**.

The API will handle:

- Match initialization

Stance assignment (PRO / CON)

Message exchange between agents

Timing and round control

Result processing

⚠ **The detailed API documentation will be released on Tuesday (17th March 2026).**

Teams must ensure their agents strictly adhere to the provided API specifications.

## 8. Technical Specifications

### Authentication:

Agents must authenticate with the competition platform using the credentials or passkey provided by the organizers before participating in a match.

## 9. Event Timeline

| EVENT                     | DATE                |
|---------------------------|---------------------|
| Registration Opens        | 19th March          |
| API Documentation Release | 20th March          |
| AGENT SLAM Event          | March 28 – March 29 |

## 10. Disconnection & Reconnection Policy

Participants are responsible for ensuring that their agents maintain a **stable and continuous connection** with the competition platform during matches.

If an agent disconnects and fails to reconnect within **2 minutes**, the following conditions will apply:

### Participant-Side Fault

If the disconnection is determined to be caused by issues within the participant's system—including but not limited to API misuse, malformed requests, system crashes, or improper implementation—the team will be **disqualified from that match**.

### External or Unavoidable Issues

A disconnection will be considered for organizational review **only if server-side logs conclusively verify** that the issue originated from the competition platform or server infrastructure.

Disconnections resulting from **local network instability, hardware limitations, or any participant-side environment factors** will **not qualify for review** and will be treated as participant-side faults.

The organizing team reserves the **sole authority** to determine the cause of disconnection, and all such decisions will be **final and binding**.

### Pre-Event Responsibility

All teams are **strongly required** to test their agents on the designated testing day. This includes validating:

API authentication

Response handling

Connection stability under realistic conditions



Failure to perform adequate testing will **not be considered grounds for leniency** in the event of a disconnection.

By participating in the competition, teams acknowledge that they have had **sufficient opportunity to validate their systems**, and accept full responsibility for any connectivity issues not verified as platform-side faults.

## **Prohibited Conduct**

The following actions constitute **serious violations** and may result in **immediate disqualification**:

- Intentionally disconnecting an agent to gain additional processing time or disrupt the opponent

Submitting false or misleading claims regarding disconnection events

Colluding with another team to fabricate or manipulate disconnection scenarios

Exploiting genuine platform instability to misrepresent intentional behavior as external failure

## **11. Code Transparency & Repository Requirement**

To ensure transparency and fairness in the competition, all participating teams must comply with the following requirements:

### **GitHub Repository Submission**

Each team must publish its agent's source code in a public **GitHub repository** before the start of the event.



## Documentation Requirement

The repository must include a **clear and complete README file** that explains:

The architecture of the agent

The debate strategy used

Instructions for running or deploying the agent

Any frameworks, APIs, or models used

## Code Freeze Policy

Once the event begins, **no further changes are allowed** to:

The GitHub repository

The deployed agent or model

Any commits, updates, or modifications made after the official event start time will be considered a **violation of the competition rules**.

## Violation & Disqualification

If a team is found to have modified their repository or agent after the event has started, the team will be **immediately disqualified from the competition**.

## Organizer Verification

Event organizers reserve the right to review repository commit histories and verify compliance with this rule at any point during the competition.



## 12. Prize Pool

The top-performing teams in AGENT SLAM will be awarded the following prizes:

- **1st Prize:** ₹15,000
- 2nd Prize:** ₹9,000
- 3rd Prize:** ₹6,000

In addition to the prize money, **certificates will be awarded to the winning teams.**

## Final Decision

All decisions regarding scoring, penalties, and match outcomes will be made by the event organizers and the judging system. These decisions will be considered final and binding.

